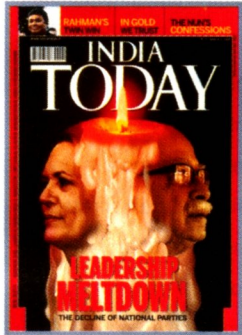


Leadership Meltdown

MARCH 9, 2009

As India gets ready for one of its biggest electoral wars, shrinking national parties are being challenged by regional allies confident of their indispensability.



“The era of coalition politics will continue in the foreseeable future unless remarkable changes are made in the operational and behavioural dynamics of both the Congress and BJP.”

DR VITULL K. GUPTA, *via www.indiatoday.in*

Failing to Lead

Regional political parties have often prospered at the cost of the national parties (“The Allied Forces”, March 9). These regional players shifted their base from the states to the Capital and soon magnified their roles enough to take on the big political outfits. Together they are a force to reckon with in national politics. So while these national-level parties were preoccupied with prime issues, regional parties made quick strides, their local approach working to their advantage.

BIDYUT KUMAR CHATTERJEE,
via www.indiatoday.in

Holy Row

There is a yawning gap between the laity and hierarchy of the Catholic Church with regard to



‘O’ Zone

Slumdog Millionaire’s award spree has proved that India is a force to reckon with (“Rahmania”, March 9). But why do we look forward to the Western world’s appreciation? Are Oscars the only yardstick to measure our creativity and performance?

MADHU SINGH SAHARAN, *via www.indiatoday.in*

Awards and achievements aside, the film is a sad reminder of the fact that despite the annual double digit economic growth and astounding progress made otherwise, India remains a poor country (“Little Big Winners”, March 2). There’s nothing wrong with the movie or its subject, but the flaw lies in our development model, level of governance and political set-up. We have failed in alleviating poverty and bringing prosperity.

SAMEER MOHINDRU, *via www.indiatoday.in*

some doctrines and many practices (“Sins of Fathers”, March 9). The hierarchy needs to pay heed to the writing on the wall and initiate action to get continuous feedback on core issues from the laity, common priests and nuns with a view to reduce this gap. It must remember that the days of pontification, imposition and claims of infallibility are over.

K.P. JOSEPH,
via www.indiatoday.in

Sop Star

In the light of a growing threat from Muslim fundamentalists across the border, there is a new alignment among the people of the majority community in the country; it will prove advantageous for the BJP, even though most Indians are not keen

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